



Reading: Elicitation Cheat Sheet

Estimated time needed: 4 minutes

In this reading, you will be able to describe each step of the elicitation process—preparation, conducting, confirmation, communication, and stakeholder collaboration—along with its goals and key activities. You will also be able to identify and explain the distinct responsibilities of Business Analysts (BAs), Project Managers (PMs), and Non-PM/Non-BA stakeholders at each stage of the elicitation process to ensure effective collaboration and clear requirements.

What is an Elicitation Cheat Sheet?

The Elicitation Cheat Sheet is a practical tool designed to help BAs, PMs, and other professionals collaborate effectively during the requirements elicitation process.

The Elicitation Cheat Sheet follows the five-step approach from the *BABOK® Guide*, outlining the goal of each step and clarifying the unique roles and responsibilities of BAs, PMs, and non-PM stakeholders such as department managers, end users, or subject matter experts.

Uses of the Elicitation Cheat Sheet

It's a good idea to use this sheet as a quick reference during projects to:

- Plan and structure elicitation activities
- Clarify who is responsible for each task
- Ensure stakeholder engagement and validation at every step

Whether you are leading the effort or supporting it, this tool helps ensure that requirements are clear, validated, and aligned with business objectives—turning conversations into actionable outcomes.

Step	Goal of the Step	Business Analyst (BA) Role	Project Manager (PM) Role	Non-PM / Non-BA Roles
1. Prepare for Elicitation	Define the purpose, scope, and approach for elicitation. Identify stakeholders, choose techniques (interviews, workshops, observation), and set expectations.	• Develop the elicitation plan and select appropriate methods. • Identify stakeholders and prepare supporting materials. • Align with PM on timing and resources.	• Integrate elicitation activities into the overall project schedule. • Ensure resources, meeting logistics, and approvals are in place. • Clarify how elicitation outputs connect to scope and objectives.	• Provide context about daily operations and business pain points. • Help identify key participants and subject matter experts. • Share availability and constraints.
2. Conduct Elicitation	Gather information through interaction, observation, and analysis to uncover needs, requirements, and constraints.	• Facilitate workshops, interviews, or focus groups. • Ask open-ended and probing questions. • Record insights objectively.	• Support sessions by ensuring stakeholder engagement and time management. • Observe alignment with project goals.	• Share real-world experiences, workflows, and challenges. • Clarify "how work really gets done." • Offer improvement ideas and confirm feasibility.
3. Confirm Elicitation Results	Validate and clarify the information gathered to ensure accuracy, completeness, and understanding.	• Summarize findings and confirm accuracy with stakeholders. • Resolve conflicting inputs. • Document assumptions and constraints.	• Review confirmed requirements for alignment with scope and deliverables. • Identify changes that may affect the schedule or cost.	• Review documented findings for accuracy. • Confirm that requirements reflect actual needs and operations. • Identify missing or misunderstood items.
4. Communicate Business Analysis Information	Organize and share elicitation results in a clear, accessible format for all audiences.	• Develop visual models, summaries, and requirement statements. • Present findings and answer clarifying questions. • Tailor communication to each audience.	• Use requirement outputs to define scope baseline and inform planning documents. • Ensure team and sponsor understand requirement impacts.	• Review materials to verify clarity. • Provide feedback on usability and completeness. • Identify potential implementation challenges.
5. Manage Stakeholder Collaboration	Maintain productive stakeholder engagement, address conflicts, and promote shared ownership throughout the lifecycle.	• Facilitate ongoing communication and collaboration. • Track stakeholder feedback and engagement. • Adjust elicitation activities as relationships evolve.	• Reinforce collaboration through governance, communication plans, and progress reviews. • Escalate unresolved issues when necessary.	• Stay engaged through reviews, testing, and change discussions. • Provide feedback and raise new needs as they emerge. • Support adoption and validation of final requirements.

Summary

In this reading, you learned that elicitation is a structured and collaborative process.

- The cheat sheet outlines a five-step approach from the *BABOK® Guide* to ensure that requirements gathering is organized, goal-oriented, and validated.
- Clearly defining the purpose, scope, and methods for elicitation ensures that all stakeholders understand expectations, timelines, and resource needs before information gathering begins.
- Facilitated discussions, interviews, and workshops uncover real business needs and constraints, with BAs focusing on discovery and PMs ensuring alignment with project objectives.
- Confirming elicited information and communicating it clearly through visual models and documentation promotes understanding, reduces errors, and builds consensus among stakeholders.
- Continuous engagement, feedback, and conflict resolution throughout the project lifecycle ensure that requirements remain accurate, relevant, and aligned with business goals.

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